

Listening List

Songs to study, grouped by the idea they show well. You don't need all of them. Pick one or two per session.

Always better: use songs he already loves. Any song with a clear verse and chorus works for mapping — J-pop, anime openings, game music with vocals, K-pop. This list is a backup.

Producer note: preview for content before playing. Use clean/radio edits where they exist.

Song structure and hooks (Sessions 1, 3)

- "Happy" — Pharrell Williams
- "Shake It Off" — Taylor Swift
- "Firework" — Katy Perry
- "Counting Stars" — OneRepublic

The four-chord loop (Session 1)

- "Let It Be" — The Beatles (I-V-vi-IV)
- "Someone Like You" — Adele (I-V-vi-IV)
- "Don't Stop Believin'" — Journey (I-V-vi-IV in the verse)
- "Despacito" — Luis Fonsi ft. Daddy Yankee (vi-IV-I-V)
- "Stand By Me" — Ben E. King (I-vi-IV-V)
- "Viva la Vida" — Coldplay (IV-V-I-vi)

Grooves (Session 2)

- Basic rock beat: "Shake It Off" — Taylor Swift
- Four on the floor: "Levitating" — Dua Lipa
- Dembow: "Despacito" — Luis Fonsi ft. Daddy Yankee

Pre-chorus (Sessions 5, 9)

- "Call Me Maybe" — Carly Rae Jepsen

- "Firework" — Katy Perry

Syncopation and flow (Session 9)

- "Uptown Funk" — Mark Ronson ft. Bruno Mars
- "Shape of You" — Ed Sheeran

Minor mood (Session 7)

- "Rolling in the Deep" — Adele
- "Believer" — Imagine Dragons
- "Zombie" — The Cranberries (same four chords as vi-IV-I-V, but it feels minor — a great "which chord is home?" debate)

Borrowed chords (Session 7)

- "In My Life" — The Beatles (listen for the minor iv chord near the end of the verse)
- "Hey Jude" — The Beatles (the long "na na na" ending uses $\flat$ VII: I- $\flat$ VII-IV-I)
- The *Super Mario Bros.* level-complete fanfare (ends $\flat$ VI- $\flat$ VII-I: the "Mario cadence")

Basslines and riffs (Session 8)

- "Another One Bites the Dust" — Queen
- "Billie Jean" — Michael Jackson
- "Seven Nation Army" — The White Stripes (a riff that sounds like a bassline)

Bridges and key changes (Session 10)

- "Love Story" — Taylor Swift (bridge, then a key change up for the final chorus)
- "Livin' on a Prayer" — Bon Jovi (key change in the final chorus)
- "Man in the Mirror" — Michael Jackson (key change)

Production (Session 11)

- "Bad Guy" — Billie Eilish (drop-outs, ear candy, unusual sounds)
- "Blinding Lights" — The Weeknd (synth layers, energy curve)